

# Serious & Chronic Illness Help

Facing cancer, a chronic disease, or another serious diagnosis — for yourself or someone you love? Organizations offer free help with treatment costs, travel, and support. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

## ⚠ BEFORE YOU START

A serious diagnosis brings both fear and financial strain. The groups below help with treatment costs, copays, travel to care, and emotional support. Ask your hospital's social worker too — they know local resources.

## 1 Help With Treatment & Copay Costs

Foundations provide grants that cover copays, medications, and treatment for many conditions.

### ☐ PAN Foundation

Copay and cost grants for dozens of chronic and serious illnesses.

→ [www.panfoundation.org](http://www.panfoundation.org)

### ☐ HealthWell Foundation

Financial help for copays, premiums, and out-of-pocket costs.

→ [www.healthwellfoundation.org](http://www.healthwellfoundation.org)

### ☐ Patient Advocate Foundation

Free case managers who help with insurance, bills, and access to care.

→ [www.patientadvocate.org](http://www.patientadvocate.org)

## 2 Cancer-Specific Support

Free practical and financial help for people facing cancer.

### ☐ American Cancer Society

Free 24/7 helpline, rides to treatment, lodging, and resource navigation.

→ [www.cancer.org](http://www.cancer.org) 1-800-227-2345

### ☐ CancerCare

Free professional support, counseling, and limited financial assistance.

→ [www.cancercare.org](http://www.cancercare.org) 1-800-813-4673

### ☐ Leukemia & Lymphoma Society

Support and financial aid for blood-cancer patients.

→ [www.lls.org](http://www.lls.org)

### 3 Rare & Chronic Diseases

Specialized help for rare conditions and ongoing chronic illness.

#### ☐ **NORD — Rare Disease Help**

Patient-assistance programs and support for rare diseases.

→ [rarediseases.org/patient-assistance-programs](https://rarediseases.org/patient-assistance-programs)

#### ☐ **Find a Disease-Specific Nonprofit**

Most major conditions have a national foundation with free help. Search the condition + “foundation” or ask in the Questions area.

→ **Search your condition + 'foundation'**

### 4 Travel, Lodging & Trials

Help getting to treatment and accessing new options.

#### ☐ **Free Medical Travel & Lodging**

Programs help with flights and lodging for treatment far from home. Ask your hospital social worker, or check the National Patient Travel Center.

→ [www.patienttravel.org](https://www.patienttravel.org)

#### ☐ **ClinicalTrials.gov**

Search studies that may offer new treatments, often at no cost.

→ [clinicaltrials.gov](https://clinicaltrials.gov)

#### **⚠ WATCH OUT FOR**

Be cautious of anyone promising a “miracle cure” for cash, or charities that spend little on patients. Stick to the established nonprofits above, and lean on your hospital’s social worker for trusted local referrals.

#### **★ A TIP THAT HELPS**

Ask your hospital for an oncology or clinical social worker — this free service is the single best way to unlock financial aid, travel help, and support you may not know exists.

#### **NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?**

#### **Need help for a specific illness?**

This guide covers national starting points. For condition-specific foundations and local support near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find them.

#### **MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID**

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